

TYLER JAMES SMITH

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EXPERIENCE

Manufacturing Engineering Intern | Smith & Wesson Brands, Inc. | Maryville, TN **May - August 2026**

Led and assisted with various engineering projects in support of manufacturing operations; learned and implemented core engineering principles. Responsible for troubleshooting, root cause analysis, solution development, and full implementation of solutions to include training of manufacturing operators.

- Designed a manufacturing process and three custom/modified fixtures—including a drilling fixture, reaming clamp, and press fixture—to support production of state-compliant fixed butt stock products.
- Validated the process through a 500-unit pilot lot, identifying further improvements that reduced cycle time by over 60%.
- Initiated a root cause analysis of 200+ out-of-specification pistol slides and identified that 75% of observed defects were associated with two machines, prompting both machines to be removed from service.
- Supported production recovery by assembling 1,100+ pistol slides; created updated work instructions and trained assembly operators.
- Designed a magazine-style loading fixture to replace a section of an existing fixture, enabling faster, more efficient staging of metal blanks for pressing.
- Modified an existing fixture by adding adjustable screws and a light-based indicator to flag striker pin deviations less than 0.010 in., signaling missing parts before assembly.
- Machined and inspected 1-2-3 blocks using milling, grinding, drilling, and tapping while holding dimensional tolerances of ± 0.001 in.

International Lean Six Sigma Green Belt | Auburn University Study Abroad | Germany **May 2026**

Earned Lean Six Sigma Green Belt certification through classroom study and an applied warehouse optimization project for Pax Bräu Brewery in Oberelsbach, Germany.

- Used DMAIC structure and Lean tools, including value stream mapping, 5 Whys analysis, and SIPOC, to address inventory flow and storage inefficiencies.
- Created storage layout recommendations estimated to reduce both retrieval time and forklift travel by 50%.
- Proposed warehouse improvements projected to increase cooler storage utilization by 87.5%.

Engineering Peer Tutor | Engineering Student Services | Auburn University, AL **January 2026 - Present**

- Deliver 6+ hours per week of tutoring across Calculus 1-3, Physics 1-2, and Engineering Statics.
- Lead biweekly 2-hour review sessions for Physics 1 test preparation with groups of 15-30 students.
- Diagnose student misconceptions and adapt explanations to improve conceptual understanding.

General Counselor | Webb School of Knoxville | Knoxville, TN **June 2025 - August 2025**

- Supervised and managed groups of 15+ children daily; enforced safety and resolved conflicts.
 - Led structured activities while improving engagement and teamwork.
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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering | Auburn University, Auburn, AL **Expected May 2028**

GPA: 3.89/4.00 | Dean's List: Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design & Manufacturing: SolidWorks (parametric modeling & assemblies), manual machining (milling, turning, grinding, drilling, tapping), fixture design, GD&T & dimension tolerancing

Process Improvement: Lean Six Sigma / DMAIC, Value Stream Mapping, 5 Whys, SIPOC, Root Cause Analysis

Software: MATLAB (simulations, data analysis, control systems), Microsoft Office Suite

PROJECTS AND LEADERSHIP

HDPE Pipe Butt Fusion Machine Design | SolidWorks | Auburn University — MECH 2220 **Spring 2026**

- Collaborated in a 5-person engineering team to design and model a 1-in HDPE pipe fusion machine in SolidWorks, comprising 15+ sub-components and sub-assemblies.
- Created parametric part models enabling iterative design updates and geometry optimization.
- Implemented 5+ design modifications to improve manufacturability and assembly efficiency.
- Addressed real-world constraints including low-cost manufacturing and deployment in resource-limited environments.

Flooring Project Manager | Phi Kappa Tau Fraternity | Auburn University, AL **August 2024 - September 2025**

- Managed a ~\$4,000 project replacing ~1,000 square feet of flooring in the fraternity house.
- Led a 40-person volunteer team to complete removal and installation.
- Saved an estimated \$10,000 in labor costs through self-performed installation.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Pi Tau Sigma — Mechanical Engineering Honor Society, Initiate	December 2025 - Present
Phi Kappa Tau — Member	August 2024 - Present
Magnolia Ave — Rhythm Guitar Player	February 2026 - Present